IB Economics - Topic 4.8: Teacher and AI Grading Guide

Measuring Development | Questions 1-30

Scope and assessment status

Each original paired question has (a) 10 marks and (b) 15 marks. All 30 questions assess shared SL/HL content. Difficulty: 6 Easy, 15 Medium, 9 Hard pairs, distributed through the bank. Level and difficulty are independent.

Single and composite measures of development, HDI, GII, IHDI, Happy Planet Index, limits of measurement and growth-development relationship. All shared SL/HL.

The uploaded Economics for the IB Diploma textbook (second edition, 2012) was used for conceptual verification. The current guide controls this topic’s numbered scope and HL boundaries.

These are original adapted Paper 1-style practice questions, not official IB examination or marking material. The question bank revisits syllabus mechanisms through distinct explanatory and evaluative tasks; the pairs are alternatives for practice, not separate official learning outcomes.

Thirty distinct pairs cover the specified measures, comparisons and limits. Further pairs would repeatedly compare the same indicators or move into development policies from Topic 4.10.

Coverage blueprint

Development: Questions 1-5

Income indicators: Questions 6-10

Health education: Questions 11-15

Inequality environment: Questions 16-20

Composite indices: Questions 21-28

Synthesis: Questions 29-30

Marking principles

Use best-fit assessment for each part, not a fixed marks-per-keyword checklist. Credit accurate alternatives addressing the task. Do not require every example or qualification below.

Part (a): 10 marks

Practice bands: 0; 1-2 limited; 3-4 mainly descriptive; 5-6 partial explanation; 7-8 clear and accurate causal analysis; 9-10 fully developed explanation with any required diagram or calculation. These abbreviated bands are not official IB descriptors.

Part (b): 15 marks

Practice bands: 0; 1-3 very limited; 4-6 superficial; 7-9 developed but weakly balanced; 10-12 balanced analysis and evaluation; 13-15 sustained, applied evaluation and supported judgment. A named case alone is not developed application.

Diagram and AI grading

For each diagram explicitly requested, credit an economically correct alternative with proper axes, equilibrium or reference lines, directions of change, and interpretation. Numerical responses require method, units and an explanation; do not award a final number with a contradictory mechanism.

Record separate marks for (a) and (b), band evidence, diagram or numerical features if relevant, economic misconceptions, quality of real-world application, and one actionable improvement per part. If a student drawing is unclear, flag the uncertainty rather than assuming correctness.

Question 1

Easy | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Development

(a) [10] Explain why economic development is a multidimensional concept.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether growth in real GDP per capita proves development.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Development includes health, education, equity and sustainability as well as income.

Required reasoning. Development includes health, education, equity and sustainability as well as income.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes development from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Development includes health, education, equity and sustainability as well as income.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why development may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 2

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Development

(a) [10] Explain the difference between economic growth and economic development.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether growth is necessary for development.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Development includes health, education, equity and sustainability as well as income.

Required reasoning. Growth is increased real output, development broader improvements; resources can help but distribution matters.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes development from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Growth is increased real output, development broader improvements; resources can help but distribution matters.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why development may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 3

Hard | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Development

(a) [10] Explain how improvements in health can raise living standards without immediately raising GDP.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether income statistics capture the value of public health.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Development includes health, education, equity and sustainability as well as income.

Required reasoning. Longer healthier lives directly improve well-being, while measured output response may lag.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes development from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Longer healthier lives directly improve well-being, while measured output response may lag.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why development may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 4

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Development

(a) [10] Explain why access to education is relevant to measuring development.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether school enrolment alone captures educational progress.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Development includes health, education, equity and sustainability as well as income.

Required reasoning. Education contributes to capabilities, but attendance differs from learning quality.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes development from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Education contributes to capabilities, but attendance differs from learning quality.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why development may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 5

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Development

(a) [10] Explain why measuring development requires attention to inequality.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether high average income is compatible with low development for many people.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Development includes health, education, equity and sustainability as well as income.

Required reasoning. Per-person income averages can mask unequal access to opportunity and services.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes development from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Per-person income averages can mask unequal access to opportunity and services.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why development may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 6

Easy | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Income indicators

(a) [10] Explain how GDP per capita at PPP adjusts a national-income comparison.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether PPP-adjusted income ranks well-being accurately.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Divide output by population and adjust for price levels, but distribution and non-market welfare remain.

Required reasoning. Divide output by population and adjust for price levels, but distribution and non-market welfare remain.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes income indicators from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Divide output by population and adjust for price levels, but distribution and non-market welfare remain.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why income indicators may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 7

Hard | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Income indicators

(a) [10] Explain why GNI per capita at PPP can differ from GDP per capita at PPP.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss which measure better reflects residents' material resources.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Divide output by population and adjust for price levels, but distribution and non-market welfare remain.

Required reasoning. GNI adds net primary income abroad, unlike territorial GDP; both are averages.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes income indicators from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. GNI adds net primary income abroad, unlike territorial GDP; both are averages.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why income indicators may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 8

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Income indicators

(a) [10] Explain why a rise in nominal GDP per capita can overstate progress.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether real income measures are sufficient for development comparisons.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Divide output by population and adjust for price levels, but distribution and non-market welfare remain.

Required reasoning. Price inflation can raise nominal incomes without more real goods, while non-income dimensions remain.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes income indicators from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Price inflation can raise nominal incomes without more real goods, while non-income dimensions remain.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why income indicators may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 9

Hard | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Income indicators

(a) [10] Explain why purchasing power parity matters when local services cost very different amounts across countries.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether PPP calculations remove every comparison problem.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Divide output by population and adjust for price levels, but distribution and non-market welfare remain.

Required reasoning. PPP equalises purchasing power of currencies for a basket, with data and quality differences.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes income indicators from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. PPP equalises purchasing power of currencies for a basket, with data and quality differences.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why income indicators may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 10

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Income indicators

(a) [10] Explain why a high-income country may have poor environmental outcomes.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether GDP per capita should receive dominant weight in a development index.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Divide output by population and adjust for price levels, but distribution and non-market welfare remain.

Required reasoning. Income can finance services yet accompany emissions and resource damage.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes income indicators from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Income can finance services yet accompany emissions and resource damage.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why income indicators may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 11

Easy | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Health education

(a) [10] Explain how life expectancy can indicate aspects of economic development.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether longevity alone measures health equity.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Longer life signals health conditions but masks within-country disparities and morbidity.

Required reasoning. Longer life signals health conditions but masks within-country disparities and morbidity.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes health education from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Longer life signals health conditions but masks within-country disparities and morbidity.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why health education may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 12

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Health education

(a) [10] Explain why infant mortality can add information to per-person income data.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether national health averages reveal access for poorer communities.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Longer life signals health conditions but masks within-country disparities and morbidity.

Required reasoning. Survival depends on nutrition and care, which GDP averages do not show.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes health education from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Survival depends on nutrition and care, which GDP averages do not show.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why health education may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 13

Hard | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Health education

(a) [10] Explain how years of schooling can contribute to a development assessment.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether years of schooling represent actual skills.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Longer life signals health conditions but masks within-country disparities and morbidity.

Required reasoning. Duration captures access but not learning or quality.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes health education from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Duration captures access but not learning or quality.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why health education may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 14

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Health education

(a) [10] Explain why literacy measures may differ from school-enrolment statistics.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether literacy is a complete education indicator.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Longer life signals health conditions but masks within-country disparities and morbidity.

Required reasoning. Literacy tracks an outcome whereas enrolment tracks participation, each incomplete.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes health education from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Literacy tracks an outcome whereas enrolment tracks participation, each incomplete.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why health education may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 15

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Health education

(a) [10] Explain why energy access can be considered a development indicator.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether more energy consumption always improves development.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Longer life signals health conditions but masks within-country disparities and morbidity.

Required reasoning. Reliable energy supports health and production, but efficiency and environmental harm matter.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes health education from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Reliable energy supports health and production, but efficiency and environmental harm matter.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why health education may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 16

Easy | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Inequality environment

(a) [10] Explain why a Gini coefficient adds information to GDP per capita.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether lower inequality necessarily means lower poverty.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Gini reflects relative income distribution; poverty is about absolute resources or thresholds.

Required reasoning. Gini reflects relative income distribution; poverty is about absolute resources or thresholds.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes inequality environment from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Gini reflects relative income distribution; poverty is about absolute resources or thresholds.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why inequality environment may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 17

Hard | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Inequality environment

(a) [10] Explain why a gender inequality measure can change the assessment of development.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether average national outcomes reveal women's opportunities.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Gini reflects relative income distribution; poverty is about absolute resources or thresholds.

Required reasoning. Aggregate averages can hide differences in health, empowerment and work.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes inequality environment from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Aggregate averages can hide differences in health, empowerment and work.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why inequality environment may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 18

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Inequality environment

(a) [10] Explain why carbon emissions per person can help evaluate sustainable development.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether low emissions always indicate successful development.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Gini reflects relative income distribution; poverty is about absolute resources or thresholds.

Required reasoning. Emissions reveal environmental pressure, but low income and outsourced emissions complicate interpretation.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes inequality environment from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Emissions reveal environmental pressure, but low income and outsourced emissions complicate interpretation.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why inequality environment may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 19

Hard | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Inequality environment

(a) [10] Explain why access to clean energy may be a better indicator than total energy use.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether energy indicators should be compared separately from income.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Gini reflects relative income distribution; poverty is about absolute resources or thresholds.

Required reasoning. Access measures basic services, while high consumption can signal waste or affluence.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes inequality environment from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Access measures basic services, while high consumption can signal waste or affluence.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why inequality environment may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 20

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Inequality environment

(a) [10] Explain why environmental indicators can conflict with income-based rankings.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether a country with high GDP per capita is necessarily more developed.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Gini reflects relative income distribution; poverty is about absolute resources or thresholds.

Required reasoning. Consumption can be high with substantial environmental costs; development involves trade-offs.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes inequality environment from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Consumption can be high with substantial environmental costs; development involves trade-offs.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why inequality environment may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 21

Easy | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Composite indices

(a) [10] Explain how the Human Development Index combines different dimensions.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether an HDI ranking is sufficient to compare quality of life.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: HDI combines health, education and income, but omits some sustainability and inequality details.

Required reasoning. HDI combines health, education and income, but omits some sustainability and inequality details.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes composite indices from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. HDI combines health, education and income, but omits some sustainability and inequality details.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why composite indices may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 22

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Composite indices

(a) [10] Explain why the inequality-adjusted HDI may differ from the ordinary HDI.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether average achievements are meaningful when distributed unequally.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: HDI combines health, education and income, but omits some sustainability and inequality details.

Required reasoning. IHDI discounts average dimensions for distributional inequality, exposing losses concealed by HDI.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes composite indices from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. IHDI discounts average dimensions for distributional inequality, exposing losses concealed by HDI.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why composite indices may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 23

Hard | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Composite indices

(a) [10] Explain what the Gender Inequality Index adds to a development comparison.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether gender gaps can persist when HDI is high.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: HDI combines health, education and income, but omits some sustainability and inequality details.

Required reasoning. GII highlights gender disadvantages in health, empowerment and labour participation.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes composite indices from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. GII highlights gender disadvantages in health, empowerment and labour participation.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why composite indices may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 24

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Composite indices

(a) [10] Explain why the Happy Planet Index can produce a different ranking from HDI.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether ecological efficiency should dominate development judgments.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: HDI combines health, education and income, but omits some sustainability and inequality details.

Required reasoning. HPI relates well-being and longevity to ecological footprint, whereas HDI emphasises income, schooling and lifespan.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes composite indices from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. HPI relates well-being and longevity to ecological footprint, whereas HDI emphasises income, schooling and lifespan.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why composite indices may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 25

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Composite indices

(a) [10] Explain why assigning weights to indicators is necessary in a composite index.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether a single development ranking can be objective.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: HDI combines health, education and income, but omits some sustainability and inequality details.

Required reasoning. Aggregation requires normative weighting and data comparability.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes composite indices from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Aggregation requires normative weighting and data comparability.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why composite indices may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 26

Easy | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Composite indices

(a) [10] Explain why two countries with the same HDI may have different development challenges.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether policy should focus on the composite score alone.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: HDI combines health, education and income, but omits some sustainability and inequality details.

Required reasoning. Different health, education and income combinations can produce similar totals.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes composite indices from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Different health, education and income combinations can produce similar totals.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why composite indices may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 27

Hard | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Composite indices

(a) [10] Explain why an IHDI gap may influence how a government interprets progress.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether faster growth in HDI ensures equitable development.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: HDI combines health, education and income, but omits some sustainability and inequality details.

Required reasoning. Large inequality loss signals uneven achievements despite rising averages.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes composite indices from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Large inequality loss signals uneven achievements despite rising averages.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why composite indices may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 28

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Composite indices

(a) [10] Explain why changing an indicator's methodology can change international rankings.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether year-to-year rank changes always represent real progress.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: HDI combines health, education and income, but omits some sustainability and inequality details.

Required reasoning. Revisions to data, weights and country coverage can shift rankings without equivalent outcomes.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes composite indices from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Revisions to data, weights and country coverage can shift rankings without equivalent outcomes.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why composite indices may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 29

Hard | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Synthesis

(a) [10] Explain why development comparisons should combine single and composite indicators.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, evaluate whether any one indicator can settle a development-policy choice.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Detailed single measures reveal particular gaps, while composites summarise multiple dimensions.

Required reasoning. Detailed single measures reveal particular gaps, while composites summarise multiple dimensions.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes synthesis from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Detailed single measures reveal particular gaps, while composites summarise multiple dimensions.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why synthesis may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Question 30

Medium | SL/HL | 25 marks

Topic 4.8: Synthesis

(a) [10] Explain how economic growth can finance health and education improvements.

(b) [15] Using real-world examples, discuss whether governments always convert growth into development.

Part (a) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Essential concepts. Development is multidimensional; income, health, education, inequality and ecological indicators reveal different aspects and limitations. Specifically: Detailed single measures reveal particular gaps, while composites summarise multiple dimensions.

Required reasoning. Higher tax base can support services, depending on spending and access.

Expected diagram or calculation. If requested, draw the correct syllabus model, label axes, initial and changed equilibria, and explain the specific mechanism in the question.

Common misconceptions. Distinguish price-level changes from exchange-rate changes, flows from stocks, and an observed correlation from a demonstrated causal effect. Do not require a neighbouring topic as essential knowledge. For this question, check specifically that the student distinguishes synthesis from nearby concepts and does not reverse the stated causal relationship.

Acceptable alternatives. Credit any other accurate economic argument, diagram or real-world example that directly addresses the specific question. Do not require a single policy conclusion or named case.

Part (b) - Indicative answer and marking guidance

Main argument. Higher tax base can support services, depending on spending and access.

Counterargument and conditions. An average or composite score can hide distribution, quality, data gaps and weighting choices. For this focus, consider why synthesis may have a different effect across countries.

Application and real-world example. UNDP country profiles let students compare HDI, IHDI and GII with GDP per capita; verify the same reference year. Credit any accurate alternative example.

Evaluation and judgment. A strong response applies the example to the stated mechanism, weighs the qualification against the main argument, and reaches a conditional conclusion. Its conclusion may differ from the suggested route if the economics and case are sound.

Sources and scope

The current IB Economics guide controls syllabus boundaries. The uploaded Economics for the IB Diploma, second edition (2012), is a supplementary conceptual check; its older chapter sequence and content cannot expand the current specification. Real-world examples are optional and should be checked against their cited sources.

IB guide. Current Economics guide, Unit 4 Topic 4.8; syllabus scope, diagrams, calculations and SL/HL boundaries.

Open source

UNDP. Human development data and index methods.

Open source

World Bank. National income and development indicators.

Open source

Final checks

30 paired questions; 6 Easy, 15 Medium, 9 Hard; All 30 questions assess shared SL/HL content. The student paper contains no answers or difficulty labels.